

August 2026

Dear Steven,

I've worked in the Lamorinda and Diablo Valley markets long enough to know that end-unit townhomes on a quiet cul-de-sac with direct trail access to Acalanes Ridge Open Space don't come along very often, and 1827 Lamplight Court caught my attention the moment it hit the market. The combination of soaring ceilings, walls of windows, and those filtered hill views in a Beacon Ridge floor plan this size is genuinely rare. When the listing came off market at 47 days without a sale, I wanted to understand why, because nothing about the home itself explains that outcome.

Forty-seven days is close to the line where buyer psychology starts to shift. When a thoughtfully maintained, turnkey property with a recently rebuilt balcony, a freshly repainted interior, and immediate access to the East Bay Regional Park trail system doesn't close inside of five weeks, the answer is almost always in the strategy, not the home. The marketing didn't fully connect the lifestyle this property offers with the buyers who would pay a premium for it, and the \$9,730 monthly HOA, which is the most significant financial fact in this listing, was never given the narrative it needed to make buyers see it as a membership in something rather than a line item on a spreadsheet.

I've put together a short packet for you that walks through the specific friction points I see in the listing history, where I think the distribution fell short, and how I'd approach a relaunch differently, starting with the story the property deserves to tell.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation whenever it suits you. No pressure either way.

With respect,



Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

1827 Lamplight Court

Walnut Creek, CA 94597

3.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,341 Sq Ft · Walnut Creek

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 1827 Lamplight Court

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Light-Filled Hilltop End Unit with Rare Trail Access - and a Listing That Undersold Both

1827 Lamplight Court brings together a set of features that Walnut Creek buyers at this price point genuinely seek out: one of the largest floor plans in Beacon Ridge, vaulted ceilings with walls of windows, direct frontage on the Acalanes Ridge Open Space trail network, and a turnkey interior that was freshly repainted in January 2026 with an updated kitchen and a rebuilt private balcony. For the right buyer, this is a move-in-ready home with an outdoor lifestyle built into the address itself.

The listing history, 47 days without an accepted offer, doesn't reflect anything wrong with the property. It reflects a strategy gap. The \$9,730 monthly HOA was the single most consequential number in this listing, and it required a clear, confident narrative about what it covers and what it buys. Without that, price-sensitive buyers experienced the fee as a cost to be avoided rather than a membership in a well-managed community. Separately, the listing description relied on all-caps fragments to flag key features rather than telling the cohesive story that would move a qualified buyer from online browsing to a scheduled showing.

\$1,289,000

List Price

\$551/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

\$9,730/mo

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to accomplish two specific things for this property: it needs to reframe the HOA as an asset and explain its value in concrete terms, and it needs to build a visual and narrative presentation that puts the trail access, the hill views, and the hilltop setting front and center before a buyer ever schedules a showing.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: The \$9,730 HOA Was Listed, Not Sold

At \$9,730 per month, the HOA is the first number a buyer's calculator reaches for, and if the marketing doesn't answer that question before the buyer asks it, the listing loses the conversation before it starts. The listing described the home's interior beautifully in places but never explained what those dues actually provide: professional management, exterior maintenance, reserves, insurance, amenities, or community infrastructure. Buyers don't dismiss a high HOA when they understand what it covers and how it simplifies ownership. They dismiss it when they're left to guess. The monthly figure needed a narrative built around it, not a footnote.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's listing strategy for HOA communities leads with a lifestyle-first narrative that itemizes what the dues buy in plain language, so buyers experience the fee as a value equation before they ever run their own numbers.

Friction #2: All-Caps Fragments in a \$1.289M Listing

The listing description contains several passages written in all caps, including the school district callout and the upstairs bedroom summary. In a price range where buyers are reading carefully and comparing multiple options, that formatting signals a form submission rather than a property worth \$1,289,000. The home has a genuinely compelling story: end-unit position, direct trail access to the East Bay Regional Park system, soaring ceilings, a rebuilt balcony, Acalanes Ridge views. That story never fully landed because the description shifted between strong prose and shouted fragments, and buyers at this price point notice the difference. The home deserved writing that matched its quality.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's listing remarks are written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home to a serious client, with Zillow Showcase placement to make sure that narrative reaches the buyers who are reading closely before they schedule anything.

Friction #3: The Trail Access and Setting Were Never the Headline

Direct access to Acalanes Ridge Open Space, connecting to the East Bay Regional Park trail system, is a feature that a specific and motivated buyer segment will pay a meaningful premium for. Dog owners, hikers, cyclists, and buyers relocating from San Francisco who want that outdoor lifestyle baked into their address, not just nearby, are a real and active part of the Walnut Creek buyer pool. The listing mentioned trails in passing near the end of the description. For the buyer who places the highest value on this feature, it should have been the first thing they saw, not the last. A hilltop end-unit townhome with immediate open space access is a rare combination, and the photography and placement never made that case.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour puts the lot position, the open space frontage, and the hilltop setting into aerial context that ground photography simply cannot replicate, giving the right buyer a reason to schedule a showing before they've even looked at the floor plan.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	1827 Lamplight Ct.	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$551/sqft	Standard updated: \$650–\$730/sqft
Lot / Setting	2,296 sqft lot, end-unit, hilltop cul-de-sac, open space frontage	Typical attached/townhome: minimal private lot, standard street position
Architectural Character	One of largest Beacon Ridge floor plans, 2,341 sqft, soaring ceilings, walls of windows	Standard townhome volume, mid-range ceiling heights
Premium Features	Rebuilt balcony, updated kitchen with skylights, fireplace, wet bar, repainted Jan. 2026	Standard builder finishes, single living area
HOA	\$9,730/mo	Walnut Creek townhome range: \$400–\$900/mo typical

The verdict: At \$551/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$650-\$730/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$551 per square foot, 1827 Lamplight Court is priced below the low end of the standard updated Walnut Creek range, which means the value case for a buyer was already present in the numbers. The challenge was never price. It was that the HOA, at \$9,730 per month, required an explicit and compelling explanation of what it provides, and the marketing didn't deliver that. A relaunch that pairs a confident HOA narrative with strong visual coverage of the open space setting gives this home a clear path to the right buyer.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Reframe the HOA as a Membership, Not a Surcharge

The \$9,730 monthly HOA is the first number a buyer's agent flags and the first objection an unrepresented buyer raises. The only way to neutralize it is to answer it before it becomes a reason to pass. That means building a clear, plain-language breakdown of what the dues cover and leading with it in every marketing channel. When buyers understand what they're buying, the fee becomes part of the value story, not an obstacle to it. BrightWork's listing campaigns treat HOA framing as a core messaging task, not an afterthought.

Pillar II - Put the Trail Access and Setting in the Opening Frame

The Acalanes Ridge Open Space connection is a feature that a defined and motivated buyer segment will actively seek out and pay for. That buyer is shopping online before they ever contact an agent, and they need to see the open space frontage and hilltop position in the first few images or they'll keep scrolling. A Sky Tour that captures the lot position relative to the ridgeline and the trail access point gives that buyer the visual confirmation they're looking for. That showing gets scheduled. The one where the trail access is mentioned in the fifth paragraph does not.

Pillar III - Match the Writing Quality to the Property Quality

A 2,341-square-foot end-unit with rebuilt balcony, vaulted ceilings, and direct trail access to the East Bay Regional Park system deserves a listing description that reads like it. The previous listing had real assets to work with, but the all-caps fragments and generic phrasing in the closing lines undercut the credibility of everything that came before it. BrightWork's Zillow Showcase listings are written as a complete narrative, so the buyer who is reading carefully, the buyer who is actually deciding, finishes the description with more confidence, not less.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

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Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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